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Project Management 7.5

Project Close Out - Getting the best from the project experience

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - State why close out is required
  - Discuss steps
  - Give examples of effective practice

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Project Closeout

The job is not over until the paperwork is done…

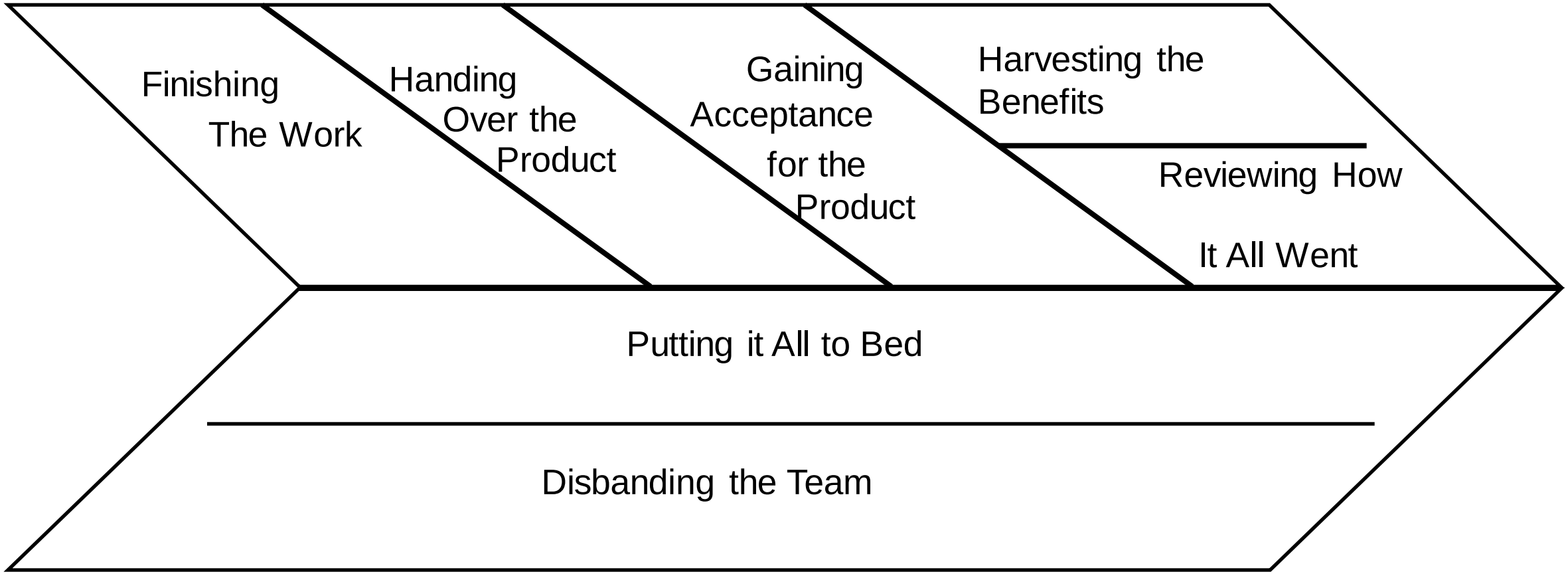
Closeout documentation is ***used to***:

- Resolve disputes
- Train project managers
- Facilitate auditing

Closeout documentation ***includes***:

- Historical records
- Post project analysis
- Financial closeout.

Elements of Project Closeout Management



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Lessons Learned

“Success is nothing more than a few simple disciplines, practiced every day, while failure is simply a few errors in judgment, repeated every day.” - Jim Rohn, entrepreneur (1930-2009)

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Lessons Learned Meetings

Common Errors

- ➢ Misidentifying **systematic errors**
- ➢ **Misinterpreting lessons** based on events
- ➢ Failure to **pass along** conclusions

Meeting Guidelines

- ✓ Establish clear rules of **behavior**
- ✓ Describe **objectively** what occurred
- ✓ Fix the **problem**, not the blame.

Knowledge Transfer by story-telling

- **Storytelling as a tool for Knowledge Transfer**
  - Storytelling to create meaning and understanding in a more transparent way.
  - They help to better transfer any information or formal knowledge in a sequential order, with priorities and including the motivation, emotion or justification
  - Storytelling is a practical and beneficial solution to bridge cultural differences between those involved.
  - Stories are not generic and relate to specific organisational and cultural conditions and therefore create a shared vision, collaboration and understanding within the team.

Wende, Erik, University of Zurich, Department of Informatics Dr. Haghirian, Parissa, Shophia University http://csrc.lse.ac.uk/asp/aspecis/20090206.pdf

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Why are Closeouts Difficult?

- ✓ Project sign off can be a de-motivator
- ✓ Constraints cause shortcuts on back-end
- ✓ Low priority activities
- ✓ Lessons learned analysis seen as book keeping

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Look Forward

- L7.6 The project evaluation